

Scammed!

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Characters:

Anirudh: Indian male about 26 year old

Entities: Unknown Humanoids

INT. ROOFTOP ROOM - EVENING

Scene is dark and we hear phone conversation between two people.

ANIRUDH

Hello, main Inspector Vijaya bol rha hu CBI ke Cybercrime Division se. Kya meri baat Mr. Sahaj Patel se ho rhi hai?

CALLEE

Ji mera hi naam hai.

ANIRUDH

Patelji, aap meri baat dhyaan se sunein aur call disconnect na karein. Aapke khilaaf serious charges hain aur filhaal aap under investigation hain.

CALLEE

Kya baat kar rhe hain?

ANIRUDH

Ji, ek overseas bank account mila hai jisse aapka phone number aur PAN linked hai. Us account se pandrah crore se zyada ke fraudulent transactions hue hain. Aur—

CALLEE

Bhai sahab kya bole ja rhe hain? Mera koi overseas account hai hi nhi.

ANIRUDH

Aapka address Anand Vihaar, Noida ka hai, aur aapka PAN number bhi usi account se linked hai.

CALLEE

Lekin sir itna bada allegation aise hi laga rhe hain aap.

ANIRUDH

Filhaal aap investigation me cooperate kijiye. Kyonki aapke naam pe arrest warrant hai.

CALLEE

Arre nhi sir, mujhe fasaya ja rha hai. Mere naam pe aaj tak chaalaan tak nhi kata, aap arrest warrant ki baat kar rhe hain.

ANIRUDH

Dekhiye isi liye keh rha hu, aap cooperate kijiye. Mai secondary verification ka process start kar rha hu. Mai aapse kuch details poochunga records se match karane ke liye, theek hai?

CALLEE

Theek hai sir.

ANIRUDH

Aapka poora naam Sahaj Kumar Patel hai, right?

CALLEE

Ji.

ANIRUDH

Apna Date of Birth bataiye.

CALLEE

22nd March, 1965.

ANIRUDH

Theek hai. Ab aapke mobile pe ek verification code aayega. Woh mujhe bata dijiye.

Anirudh initiates Marauder Script.

ANIRUDH

Check kijiye.

CALLEE

Ji... 5182...(Inaudible)

ANIRUDH

Theek hai Patelji. Aapne investigation me poora cooperate kiya. Mai aapka arrest warrant hold pe daal rha hu. Ab aap nischint rahiye.

CALLEE

Theek hai sir, dhanyawaad.

ANIRUDH

Chaliye. Shubh ratri.

Satisfied. Anirudh hangs up. Marks lead as "Harvest Complete". He leans back on his chair and checks time. Suddenly his phone rings. Caller ID says Supervisor sir.

ANIRUDH

Hello?

SUPERVISOR

Updated list mila ki nahi tumko,
Anirudh?

ANIRUDH

Um- check kar rha hu sir.

SUPERVISOR

Check karke batao kitne leads hain
total?

ANIRUDH

30 hain sir.

SUPERVISOR

20 Harvest chahiye. Ho jaayega?

ANIRUDH

20 Harvest?

SUPERVISOR

Minimum 20.

ANIRUDH

Hmm...

SUPERVISOR

Ek high value target hai. Uska
Document alag se hai. Call karne
se pehle dekh lena jaroor.

ANIRUDH

Hanji bilkul.

SUPERVISOR

Chalo shuru kar do.

Anirudh he cracks his fingers. Pick the first target in the list. Dials the number using the CRM tool. The call connects after a few seconds.

CALLEE

Hello?

ANIRUDH

Hello, main Inspector Vijaya bol
rha hu CBI ke Cybercrime Division
se. Kya meri baat Mr. Gopiraj se
ho rhi hai?

CALLEE

Ji nhi, mai unka beta bol rha hu.
Kya chahiye aapko?

ANIRUDH

Gopiraj ji ko phone dijiyega.
Mujhe unse hi baat karni hai.

CALLEE

Pitaji busy hain. Aap mujhse hi baat kijiye.

ANIRUDH

Accha? Jinse baat ho rhi hai unka naam?

CALLEE

Aapki baat desh ke Pradhaan Mantri se ho rhi hai.

ANIRUDH

Ye kaun sa tareeka hai baat karne ka, han? Tumhaare pitaji jail ja sakte hain aur tumko mazak soojh rha hai?

CALLEE

Haan kya? Kis khushi mein jail ja sakte hain woh?

ANIRUDH

CBI ki investigation hai. Case details tumhaare saath share nahi kar sakta. Apne papa se meri baat kara do, warna tumhaare liye bhi problem ho sakta hai.

CALLEE

Phone toh nhi de rha mai. Baaki hum bhi thoda jaanein ki kya problem hogi.

ANIRUDH

Theek hai. Investigation mein cooperate nahi karna bhi offence hai. Tumhaare against bhi warrant issue karwa deta hu.

CALLEE

(Laughs)

Accha? Itna aukaat hai kya tumhara?

ANIRUDH

Abhi aur hasi aayegi. Tere naam pe itne cases khlunga na, gin nhi paayega.

CALLEE

Aur tere naam pe OnlyFans kholunga. Bees रुपये mein mujra karwaunga tujhse saale.

ANIRUDH

Tu government officer se battameezi kar raha hai. Samajh nahi aa raha tujhe kya hoga.

CALLEE

Arre ja jo ukhaarna hai ukhaar le.
Bohot dekhe hain tere jaise.

ANIRUDH

Ruk. Batata hu tujhe—

Call disconnects abruptly cutting Anirudh off. He mutters something to himself angrily while shaking his fist. Silence for few seconds.

Suddenly there is a loud thud outside his room. He is startled. He grabs a stick and his mobile. Turns on flashlight and goes outside his room. There is a wooden chair outside which has toppled. He goes outside and sits it up again. The chair now casts a shadow into the room through the door.

He relaxes and then returns to his workstation to mark the lead as failed. Checks another lead and hesitates for some time. Then he takes a deep breath and starts calling the numbers. CALL MONTAGE BEGINS.

ANIRUDH

(Montage repeat)

Hello, Inspector Vijaya bol rha hu
CBI, Cybercrime division se

ANIRUDH

(Montage Cuts)

Kya meri baat Mr. Piyush se ho rhi
hai?
Kya meri baat Mrs. Payal se ho rhi
hai?
Kya meri baat Mohd. Sarfaraaz se
ho rhi hai?

ANIRUDH

(Montage Cuts)

Aapke against serious charges
hain.
Aapke naam pe illegal transfers
hue hain.

ANIRUDH

(Montage Cuts)

Verification code share kijiye.
Verification code aaya hoga aapko.
Verification code ko padhiye.

INT. ROOFTOP ROOM - LATE EVENING

Anirudh looks at the Sheet and the next person is named as Mahutla Surashendu, note beside his name says: Ex-Diplomat, High Value Target, Refer Doc-13 for more intel. Anirudh opens Doc-13 and it has some information like: Possible off-shore accounts. Previously booked for unverified money transfers, released due to lack of evidence. Associated with with Sleeper blocks and was investigated under UAPA, results inconclusive. Mention of term Outpost-225 in several old intelligence reports. No information regarding what that is.

After reading the doc he checks the number. His number is 112005116.

ANIRUDH

Ab ye kaisa number hai?

He asks himself as he dials it. Call connects after few seconds.

CALLEE

Hello

ANIRUDH

Hello, main Inspector Vijaya bol rha hu CBI ke Cybercrime Division se. Kya meri baat Mr. uh-Mahutla se ho rhi hai?

CALLEE

Ji bol rha hu.

ANIRUDH

Mahutilaji mai investigating officer hu ek case file pe, aapke naam ka ek previous case reopen hua hai. Toh usi ke baare me mujhe aapse kuch sawaal poochne hain.

CALLEE

Mr. Jo bhi naam hai aapka. I used to be a Diplomat, okay? Aise call pe kaun si government agency threaten karti hai? You think I am an idiot?

ANIRUDH

Careful Mr. Mahutla, humein underestimate karne ki galti mat kijiyege. We know everything about your past.

CALLEE

Nonsense! You know absolutely nothing.

ANIRUDH

We know about your offshore accounts and your association with Sleeper cells. We can do more
(MORE)

ANIRUDH (CONT'D)
damage to your reputation than you think.

CALLEE
You are just wasting my time. Kisi aur ko jaake bother kijiye.

ANIRUDH
What if I tell you that I know everything about Outpost Two Twenty Five.

CALLEE
(Few seconds silence)
Sorry, come again?

ANIRUDH
I said mujhe Outpost Two Two Five ke baare me sab kuch pata hai.

CALLEE
(Again few seconds silence)
Hmm... Call me on my secure line. Note kijiye number-005172007.

Call disconnects. Anirudh is shaking a bit. He dials the number that callee gave him. Call connects.

ANIRUDH
Hello?

CALLEE
Hanji, iss line se connect karwane ka ek hi purpose hai, aapko batana ki there is a certain line you should not cross.

ANIRUDH
Aye! Dhamkane ki koshish kar rha hai tu mujhe?

CALLEE
Oh no not at all. Please enjoy the music I will be right back.

ANIRUDH
What?

Strange high pitched mechanical noise blurts from the speaker. Anirudh move the phone away from himself. Slowly brings it closer. The noise continues for sometime. Then stops.

ANIRUDH
Hello?

CALLEE
I hope you enjoyed the music.

ANIRUDH

Kya tha woh?

CALLEE

Oh nothing to worry about. Have a nice day.

Before Anirudh can say something call disconnects. He sinks his face into his hands and stays like that for a while.

Camera slowly pans and we can see that there is a shadow of a person sitting on the chair. Then, there is a single knock/tap on a nearby door. Anirudh raises his head up and looks to his side. Notices the shadow. The shadow gets up and leaves to the right.

Anirudh is alarmed. He grabs his stick and mobile again and checks outside through the door. At a distance feet of a person is barely visible emerging near a wall turn at the end of the roof. It slowly pulls backwards.

Anirudh goes outside and checks around the roof. Sees absolutely nothing. Scratches his head and returns back to his room. Before returning to his workstation he secures the aldrop to lock the door. Then returns back to his workstation and this time he rotates his chair slightly to keep an eye on the door.

Then starts calling people again. Next person is Shubhankar from Kolkata. He dials the number and call connects.

CALLEE

Hello, ke?

ANIRUDH

Hello, main Inspector Vijaya bol rha hu CBI ke Cybercrime Division se. Kya meri baat Mr. Shubhankar se ho rhi hai?

CALLEE

(Speaks to someone else nearby)

NBI? Arre NBI theke bolche kyeu, 1 min.

ANIRUDH

Hello Shubhankar ji?

CALLEE

Ji ji bataiye.

ANIRUDH

Shubhankar ji mujhe ek case file pa assign kiya gaya hai jisme ki aapka naam saamne aaya hai. Hello?

Some commotion is audible on the other side.

CALLEE

(Speaks to someone else nearby)

Arre darao na, kotha bolchi karur shaathe.

ANIRUDH

Shubhankarji! Kya aap meri baat pe thoda focus karenge please?

CALLEE

(Speaks sternly)

Arre kaun Shubhankar? Mai Gopiraj bol rha hu. Aapko baat karni tha na mujhse?

ANIRUDH

Gopiraj? Meri Shubhankarji se baat ho rhi thi na? Ye kisko call lag gaya? Hello Shubhankarji?

CALLEE

(Voice slightly garbled)

Arre bhai sahab mai Gopiraj baat kar rha hu. Aapki baat hui thi mere bete se. Usne bataya ki bade battameez type ke aadmi ho tum.

Confused Anirudh drops the call abruptly. He checks the number again. The call log shows Shubhankar.

ANIRUDH

Ye log toh Shubhankar hi dikha rha hai. Kisko call lag gaya?

He checks the number and dials again. Call connects.

CALLEE

Hello?

ANIRUDH

Hello? Shubhankarji?

CALLEE

Arre dada aapko mujhse baat karna hai ya Gopiraj ji se aap ye clear kijiiye na?

ANIRUDH

Kya? Gopiraj ji hain kya aapke saath wahan?

CALLEE

Arre nhi dada yahan koi Gopiraj naam ka nahi rehta yahi toh bata rha hu aapko kab se.

ANIRUDH

Accha koi baat nhi line mix ho gaya hoga, filhaal aap meri baat suniye dhyaan se. Aapke naam pe case register hua hai. Aapka naam aur Adhaar number linked hain Kolkata me kuch properties se jinko illegally khareeda gaya hai.

CALLEE

Kya aaltu faaltu baat kar rhe hain? Mere naam pe koi property nhi hai. Mai rented flat me rehta hu-with family.

ANIRUDH

Dekhiye Gopirajji-sorry, I mean Shubhankarji-

CALLEE

(Angrily, Garbled)

Kaisa battameez aadmi hai re tu. Kya bol rha tha tu mere bete batana zara?

ANIRUDH

Shubhankarji? Aapke bete se kab baat hui meri?

CALLEE

(Angrily, Garbled)

Arre mai Gopiraj bol rha hu! Mere bete se battameezi ki toh kaat dalunga tujhe isse-ye dekh-

At the corner of his eye just outside his window he notices a hand holding a small hatchet just outside his door/window. But the moment he looks at the hand it pulls backward.

Alarmed Anirudh drops his headphone, grabs his stick again and turns on flashlight. Looks outside the door slowly, fearfully. Again nothing. The call has been disconnected. He sits down on his chair and looks around confused.

ANIRUDH

Saala, kya ho rha hai ye mere saath?

Anirudh pulls out a padlock from his drawer. Walks up to the door and proceeds to secure it with the padlock. He then checks the next target on the list.

As he checks he notices several names on the top of the list now have "DECEASED" in the Notes section of the list.

ANIRUDH

Ye maine kab likha?

As he clicks on them they disappear. He then dials the next number. Call connects.

CALLEE

Hello kaun?

ANIRUDH

Hello, main Inspector Vijaya bol rha hu CBI ke Cybercrime Division se. Kya meri baat Usman ji se ho rhi hai?

CALLEE

Kya chahiye aapko?

ANIRUDH

Usman ji mujhe ek case file pa assign kiya gaya hai jisme ki aapka naam saamne aaya hai.

CALLEE

(Static and Garbled voice)

Yahi kahan tha na tune Patelji se bhi?

ANIRUDH

(Flabbergasted)

Kya? Kya bol rhe hain?

CALLEE

(Distressed)

Sab yaad hai mujhe.

INT. ROOFTOP ROOM - LATE NIGHT

Anirudh looks at the final entry in the Sheet. It says Anirudh G. He is shocked. He picks up his phone and calls his manager.

ANIRUDH

Hello sir.

SUPERVISOR

Hanji Anirudh bhai, kya hua?

ANIRUDH

Sir, ye mera naam list pe kyon hai?

SUPERVISOR

Han? Kya bol rhe ho? Tumhara naam kyon hoga list pe?

ANIRUDH

Sir, ispe Anirudh G likha hai and this looks like my number.

SUPERVISOR

Toh tum keh rhe ho poori duniya bus tum hi ek Anirudh G ho?

ANIRUDH

But sir, ye number...

SUPERVISOR

Bhai tumne Ganja phoonk liya hai kya? Kya ulta seedha bol rhe ho?

ANIRUDH

Nhi sir, pata nhi kya ho rha hai. But lag rha hai ye mera number.

SUPERVISOR

Abe phone kar aur dekh le na? Kya time kharab kar rha hai mera.a

ANIRUDH

Sir kuch theek nhi lag rha mujhe.

SUPERVISOR

Sun mere bhai, ek ehsaan kar mere upar. List khatam kar, aur report submit karde. Please, raat ke 11 baj rhe hain mujhse aur nhi ho rha.

ANIRUDH

Suniye toh sir, Kuch toh bohot ajeeb sa hi ho rha hai yahan.

SUPERVISOR

(Voice getting Garbled)

Anirudh list khatam kar de... List khatam kar de Anirudh...

ANIRUDH

Kya hua sir?

Call disconnects.

ANIRUDH

Hello? Hello?

Anirudh puts the phone down.

PHONE

(Garbled Voice)

List khatam kar...

ANIRUDH

What the fuck? Ye kya tha?

Scared, he looks around the room and the door. He gets up, picks up the door key and goes near the door. He tries opening but sees that the lock is on the other side of the door. He realizes he is trapped in the room.

ANIRUDH

Oh fuck. Kya karun, kya karun mai!

Anirudh picks up his phone and dials Emergency number.
Someone picks up on the other side.

SUPERVISOR

Hello, Anirudh? Fir se kyon call
kiya? Report daal di tune?

ANIRUDH

What? No sir! Maine aapko nhi call
kiya! Mai toh... Mai toh... ye
Emergency no pe call kiya.

SUPERVISOR

Are you out of your mind? Abe
Emergency number kyon dial kar rha
hai? Dimaag sahi me kharab ho gaya
hai kya tumhara?

ANIRUDH

No Sir! Baat samajhiye. Mai apne
hi room me band ho gaya hu sir. I
need help, mujhe samajh me nhi aa
rha hai kya karun.

SUPERVISOR

(Voice getting Garbled)

Maine kaha na List khatam karne
ko... List khatam kar de
Anirudh...

Anirudh hangs up. He grabs his head in distress. He slowly
approaches his PC. Then opens the dialer and types in the
number. Hesitantly presses Dial.

Silence hangs for 15-20 seconds. Then his personal phone
starts ringing. Caller ID says Unknown Number. Anirudh slowly
picks up.

ANIRUDH

Hel...Hello?

VOICE

(Same sound as Anirudh)

Hello, main Inspector Vijaya bol
rha hu CBI ke Cybercrime Division
se. Kya meri baat Mr. Anirudh-ji
se ho rhi hai?

ANIRUDH

(Panicking)

Kya? Kaun bol rha hai?

VOICE

Main Inspector Vijaya bol rha hu,
mujhe assign kiya gaya hai ek case
file me, jispe ki aapka naam
saamne aaya hai...

ANIRUDH

Nhi nhi nhi. Ye nhi ho sakta.
Kaise? Ye nhi ho sakta.

Anirudh drops his phone. Entities enter his room. Anirudh hides.

VOICE

Hello sir, meri awaaz aa rhi hai
aapko? Hello?

Entities surround Anirudh, camera fades.

FADE OUT